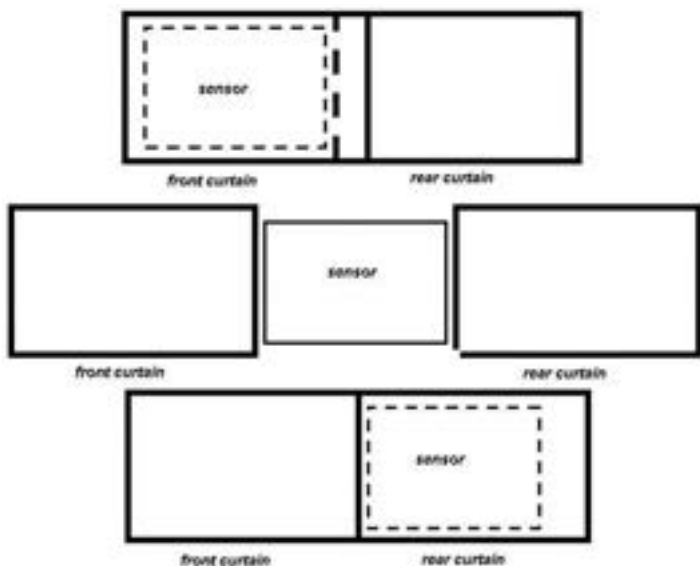


Flash sync speeds are measured in fractions of seconds and the only camera setting that the flash sync speed impacts is shutter speed. Each camera comes with a maximum sync speed beyond which your shutter cannot go, unless you turn the built-in flash off.

Shutter Curtains

Focal plane shutters are typically made of two 'curtains' – a front curtain and a rear one. The front one opens to start the exposure and the rear one closes up behind it to end it. Usually, the flash sync fires at the same moment as the opening of the front curtain and is known as 'front curtain sync'. However, certain cameras set the flash sync to fire just before the rear curtain closes known as 'rear curtain sync'.



Shutters are often just a couple of shifty curtains

Sometimes, when you take a snap of a moving car in the night, you'll find the headlights appear to be trailing ahead of the subject. This is because of front curtain sync occurring during a long exposure. Except for such occasions, front cur-